

How to Apply Health and Safety Measures

Sub-Topic: Workstation Health Risk Assessment Methods & Good Posture

1. Importance of Taking Breaks

When working on complex problems or dealing with heavy workloads, it is vital to take regular breaks (such as micro-breaks, lunchtime breaks, and longer breaks) to maintain well-being and productivity.

Benefits of taking regular breaks:

- **Avoids Mental Fatigue:** Prevents impairments in concentration, memory, and decision-making.
- **Reduces Stress & Burnout:** Helps manage stress levels, protecting mood, motivation, and performance.
- **Recharges Energy:** Stepping away for a few minutes refreshes the mind and restores focus.
- **Enhances Work Quality:** Boosts overall work quality and output.
- **Stimulates Creativity:** Allows you to generate new ideas, perspectives, and solutions.
- **Improves Learning:** Helps consolidate and process information for better retention.
- **Increases Efficiency:** Minimizes errors and enhances problem-solving skills.

2. Adopting Good Sitting Posture

Good posture respects the natural position of our joints and maintains the body's muscular balance. Key guidelines for an ideal sitting position at a computer include:

- Keep your back straight and avoid rounding your shoulders forward (keep your screen at eye level to support this).
- Avoid rounding or arching your lower back.
- Keep your shoulders relaxed and back.
- Place your elbows so they form a 90° – 100° angle (never less).
- Keep your knees at the height of your hips (thighs should form a 90° – 100° angle with the torso).
- Leave your legs relaxed, bent at about 90° – 100° with feet resting flat on the ground (do not cross legs).

3. Use of Document Holders

- **Purpose:** Holds printed materials close to the user and the monitor during computer tasks.
- **Benefits:** Proper placement reduces or eliminates risk factors such as awkward head/neck postures, fatigue, headaches, and eye strain.
- **Placement:** Position depends on the task and document type, and must be well-adjusted relative to the monitor, keyboard, and chair.

4. Posture and Spectacles

- Wearing computer eyeglasses helps reduce glare.
- It stops users from leaning in or hunching over the screen to see better, thereby improving overall posture.

Safety Measures in Risk Reduction at Workstations

Sub-Topic: Audio Settings & Electrical Safety

1. Setting Volume Levels for Speakers and Earpieces (in Windows)

To protect hearing and ensure safety, volume levels can be properly adjusted through the Control Panel using the following steps:

1. Search for and select **Control Panel** in the Windows search bar.
2. Select **Sound**.
3. Select **Properties** for the specific audio device.
4. Go to the **Levels** tab to adjust and set the volume level. Select other devices to change their levels as needed.

2. Avoiding the Overloading of Sockets

Overloading sockets can cause wall plugs to overheat and potentially start a fire.

Top tips to prevent overloading:

- **Check Extension Lead Ratings:** Always know the rating before plugging in appliances (most leads are rated at 13A or less).
- **Know Total Current and Wattage:** Ensure the combined amperage and wattage of plugged-in appliances do not exceed the maximum rating of the lead. The total wattage must not exceed **3000W**.
- **Use One Extension Lead Per Socket:** Never plug an extension lead into another extension lead (daisy-chaining).
- **Avoid Block Adaptors:** Use multiway bar extension leads instead of plastic block adaptors, as block adaptors often lack fuses and are unsafe.
- **Install More Sockets:** If an area regularly requires extension cords, have a registered electrician install extra double wall sockets.

3. Regular Danger Signs to Check For

Always look out for suspicious or unusual signs around electrical connections, including:

- Smell of hot plastic (melting sockets or appliances).
- Sparks or scorch marks around a socket, plug, or appliance.
- Damaged, frayed, or exposed colored wires inside leads.
- Fuses that repeatedly blow for no apparent reason.